Outlook

Opposition to Data Center

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To Gary Jungermann <GJungermann@Callawaycounty.org>; Christopher Scott <cscott@callawaycounty.org>; Curt Warfield <cwarfield@callawaycounty.org>; Jim.Schulte@house.mo.gov <Jim.Schulte@house.mo.gov>

Dear Commissioners and Mr. Schulte ,
I am a resident of Callaway County and I am writing to formally express my opposition to the proposed data center project in Callaway County, unless proper protections for the community are in place.

While I support economic development, I believe AI data centers and similar business projects present significant risks to our community that must be properly mitigated.

My concerns include:
1. Environmental Impact: The potential for excessive water consumption and noise pollution from cooling systems and generators.
2. Grid Reliability: The immense energy demands could cause utility rates to rise for local residents.
3. Land Use: This project does not align with the rural/residential character of our area, disrupting agricultural land and local wildlife.
4. The tax implications to current residents due to the previous tax breaks centers have received.

While these facilities provide tax revenue, they are intense industrial users that require careful regulation to be "good neighbors". At a minimum, please consider the following when evaluating new proposals:

* Mandating noise mitigation: Restricting chiller operations to meet noise limits at property lines.
* Environmental Protection: Prohibiting projects in floodplains or areas with high water tables, and regulating water and electric usage such that it does not impact the availability or costs of these basic utilities for the citizens of the surrounding communities.
* Thermal Pollution Study: Evaluating the impact of "heat domes" on surrounding agriculture.

At minimum, I urge the commission to institute a moratorium to conduct a comprehensive impact study before approving any such project.

Sincerely,

Kim Lorentz